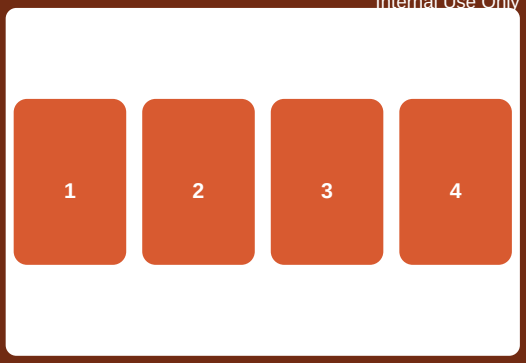
PEOPLE & CI

Internal Use Only

Customer Gemba

Visit the customer's actual environment to directly observe how they use your product or service — generating insight



WHEN TO USE

Before redesigning a product or service; when satisfaction scores are falling; when customer needs are assumed rather than observed.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Define specific observation objectives before the visit
2. Go to the customer's location — do not invite them to yours
3. Observe and listen without defending, selling, or explaining
4. Ask open questions: 'Can you show me exactly how you use this?'
5. Debrief the team immediately after and integrate insights into improvement plans

PRACTITIONER TIP

! The most important word in 'Customer Gemba' is Gemba — the real place. Insights come from observation, not surveys or meetings.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Structured observation notes
- Customer insight summary with direct quotes
- Prioritised improvement opportunities ranked by customer impact

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Insights generated per visit; improvement actions taken per quarter; NPS or CSAT before and after acting on insights

TOOL CATEGORY
People & CI